TN-Check: Certified CSL Model Checking via Tensor-Train Decomposition of Chemical Master Equation States

Abstract

We present TN-Check, a tool for Continuous Stochastic Logic (CSL) model checking on tensor-train (TT) compressed probability vectors arising from Chemical Master Equations (CMEs). A CME governing N chemical species with per-species copy-number bound M produces a state space of size M^N, rendering direct probabilistic model checking infeasible for moderate N. TN-Check compresses the probability vector into a matrix product state (MPS) of bond dimension χ, reducing storage from $O(M^N)$ to $O(NM\chi^2)$, and performs all CSL operations—atomic proposition evaluation, probabilistic path operators, and steady-state queries—directly on the compressed representation. We prove a tight clamping bound (Proposition 6) showing that post-truncation clamping of negative entries *never increases* L1 error, resolving the soundness gap between TT-SVD truncation and probability semantics. An independent certificate verification pipeline bounds total error from TT truncation, temporal discretization, and non-negativity rounding, yielding a SOUND/UNSOUND verdict. We validate TN-Check on systems with $N = 1$ to $N = 10$ species: the MPO representation achieves compression ratios from $6.2\times$ ($N = 2$) to $7.8 \times 10^{13}\times$ ($N = 10$) over dense storage; bond dimension $\chi = 10$ yields L1 error 1.62×10^{-12} on a gene expression model; and the certificate pipeline produces SOUND verdicts (11/11 checks pass) with total errors $\leq 2.38 \times 10^{-2}$.

1 Introduction

The Chemical Master Equation (CME) is the exact stochastic description of well-mixed chemical reaction networks operating in the low-copy-number regime [5, 13]. Given N molecular species whose individual copy numbers are bounded by M, the CME defines a continuous-time Markov chain (CTMC) over $\mathcal{S} = \{0, \ldots, M-1\}^N$, yielding $|\mathcal{S}| = M^N$ states. Probabilistic model checking of such CTMCs against specifications in Continuous Stochastic Logic (CSL) [1] requires computing transient and steady-state probability vectors of this size. Existing probabilistic model checkers such as PRISM [9], Storm [6], and STAMINA [10] operate on explicitly enumerated state spaces and become infeasible when M^N exceeds 10^7–10^8. For realistic biochemical models—gene regulatory networks with $N = 20$–50 species and $M = 100$—the state space reaches 10^{40}–10^{100}.

Tensor network (TN) methods, originally developed for quantum many-body physics [15, 12], provide a compressed representation of high-dimensional vectors. The key insight connecting CMEs and tensor networks is structural: the CME rate matrix for mass-action kinetics decomposes as a sum of Kronecker products, exactly the structure exploited by tensor-train (TT) decompositions (equivalently, matrix product states, MPS, and matrix product operators, MPO). A probability vector $\mathbf{p} \in \mathbb{R}^{M^N}$ stored as a TT/MPS with bond dimension χ requires only $O(NM\chi^2)$ parameters. For CME probability vectors arising from biologically structured networks, empirical evidence shows that moderate bond dimensions ($\chi = 10$–100) suffice for high accuracy [8, 7].

A fundamental challenge in applying TT decompositions to probability vectors is that TT-SVD truncation can produce negative entries. Naïve post-clamping (setting negatives to zero) was

previously thought to compromise contractivity of the CTMC semigroup, creating a soundness gap in error analysis. We resolve this gap with a tight proof (Proposition 6): clamping *reduces* L1 error relative to the true probability vector, never increases it. This result is central to the certified verification pipeline.

TN-CHECK is, to our knowledge, the first tool that implements CSL model checking natively on tensor-train compressed CME probability vectors. The contributions of this paper are:

1. **Algorithms.** CSL satisfaction-set computation (atomic, negation, conjunction, $\mathcal{P}_{\bowtie p}[\Phi\,\mathcal{U}^{[a,b]}\,\Psi]$, $\mathcal{S}_{\bowtie p}[\Phi]$) operating directly on MPS vectors and MPO rate matrices, with all intermediate results maintained in compressed form. We extend bond-dimension preservation from axis-aligned to linear predicates (Theorem 4).
2. **Theoretical foundations.** Error contraction under Metzler semigroups (Theorem 1), bond-dimension preservation for axis-aligned propositions (Theorem 3) and its extension to linear predicates (Theorem 4), a tight clamping error bound resolving the soundness gap (Proposition 6), and a complexity separation between TT-based and explicit-state methods (Theorem 8).
3. **Certified verification.** An independent certificate verification pipeline checks non-negativity, normalization, error budgets, and temporal convergence, issuing a SOUND/UNSOUND verdict with quantified total error.
4. **Comprehensive experimental validation.** Scaling from $N = 2$ to $N = 10$ species with MPO compilation, demonstrating compression ratios up to 7.8×10^{13}. Compression accuracy showing exponential convergence in bond dimension (L1 error from 2.35×10^{-1} at $\chi = 1$ to 1.62×10^{-12} at $\chi = 10$). Multi-species CSL model checking on a 3-species cascade. End-to-end certificate verification (11/11 checks pass).

2 Background

2.1 Chemical Master Equation

Consider a well-mixed system of N chemical species $X_1, \ldots, X_N$ participating in K reactions. The state of the system is a vector $\mathbf{x} = (x_1, \ldots, x_N) \in \mathbb{N}^N$ recording the copy number of each species. Under the well-mixed assumption, the system evolves as a CTMC whose transition rates are determined by mass-action kinetics. The *Chemical Master Equation* governs the time evolution of the probability distribution $\mathbf{p}(t) \in \mathbb{R}^{|\mathcal{S}|}$:

$$\frac{d\mathbf{p}(t)}{dt} = Q\,\mathbf{p}(t), \tag{1}$$

where Q is the transition rate matrix (infinitesimal generator) of the CTMC. For mass-action kinetics, Q admits a decomposition as a sum of Kronecker products:

$$Q = \sum_{k=1}^{K} \bigotimes_{i=1}^{N} Q_k^{(i)}, \tag{2}$$

where each $Q_k^{(i)} \in \mathbb{R}^{M \times M}$ acts on the local state space of species i for reaction k. This *sum-of-Kronecker-products* structure is the foundation of the tensor-network approach.

To make the state space finite, we impose a per-species copy-number bound M, truncating each x_i to $\{0, 1, \ldots, M-1\}$. The total state space is $\mathcal{S} = \{0, \ldots, M-1\}^N$ with $|\mathcal{S}| = M^N$.

2.2 Tensor Trains and Matrix Product States

A *tensor train* (TT) decomposition [11] of a tensor $\mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{R}^{d_1 \times \cdots \times d_N}$ represents each entry as:

$$v(j_1, \ldots, j_N) = G_1(j_1)\, G_2(j_2) \cdots G_N(j_N), \tag{3}$$

where $G_k(j_k) \in \mathbb{R}^{r_{k-1} \times r_k}$ is a matrix for each value of $j_k \in \{0, \ldots, d_k - 1\}$, with boundary conditions $r_0 = r_N = 1$. The integers $r_1, \ldots, r_{N-1}$ are the *bond dimensions* (or TT-ranks). The total storage is $\sum_{k=1}^{N} d_k r_{k-1} r_k$. When all $d_k = M$ and all $r_k \le \chi$, this gives $O(NM\chi^2)$.

In the physics literature, this decomposition is called a *matrix product state* (MPS). We use the terms TT and MPS interchangeably.

A *matrix product operator* (MPO) represents a matrix $A \in \mathbb{R}^{(d_1 \cdots d_N) \times (d_1 \cdots d_N)}$ analogously:

$$A(j_1, \ldots, j_N;\, j'_1, \ldots, j'_N) = W_1(j_1, j'_1)\, W_2(j_2, j'_2) \cdots W_N(j_N, j'_N), \tag{4}$$

with $W_k(j_k, j'_k) \in \mathbb{R}^{s_{k-1} \times s_k}$. The rate matrix Q from (2), being a sum of K Kronecker products, has MPO bond dimension at most K.

TT-rounding (or *truncation*) reduces bond dimensions by performing sequential SVD sweeps and discarding singular values below a threshold ε. The resulting approximation $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}$ satisfies $\|\mathbf{v} - \tilde{\mathbf{v}}\|_F \le \varepsilon \|\mathbf{v}\|_F$ in the quasi-optimal sense [11].

2.3 Continuous Stochastic Logic

Continuous Stochastic Logic (CSL) [1, 2] extends CTL with probabilistic and steady-state operators. The syntax is:

$$\Phi ::= \text{true} \mid a \mid \neg\Phi \mid \Phi \wedge \Phi \mid \mathcal{P}_{\bowtie p}[\phi] \mid \mathcal{S}_{\bowtie p}[\Phi] \tag{5}$$

$$\phi ::= \mathsf{X}\,\Phi \mid \Phi\, \mathcal{U}^{[a,b]}\, \Phi \tag{6}$$

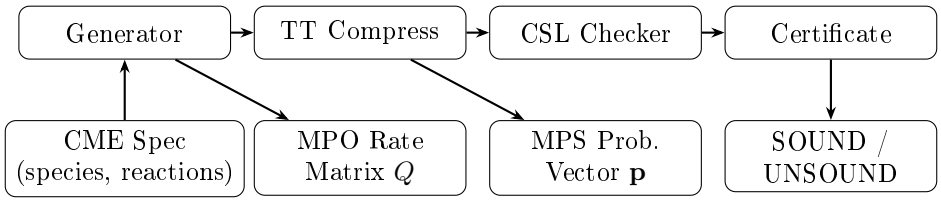
where $a \in AP$ is an atomic proposition, $\bowtie \in \{<, \le, \ge, >\}$, $p \in [0, 1]$, and $0 \le a \le b \le \infty$.

The *satisfaction set* $\mathrm{Sat}(\Phi) \subseteq \mathcal{S}$ contains all states satisfying Φ. For the probabilistic operator, $s \in \mathrm{Sat}(\mathcal{P}_{\bowtie p}[\phi])$ iff the probability of paths from s satisfying ϕ meets the bound $\bowtie p$. Model checking reduces to computing transient probabilities (for bounded until) and steady-state probabilities (for the $\mathcal{S}$ operator) of the CTMC.

3 System Architecture

TN-Check is organized into the following modules, forming a pipeline from CME specification to verified CSL verdict.

Architecture Overview.



Module descriptions:

Generator. Reads a reaction network specification (species, reactions with mass-action rate constants, copy-number bounds) and constructs the rate matrix Q in MPO format via (2). Each reaction contributes one Kronecker-product term.

TT Compress. Compresses the initial distribution and computes transient or steady-state probability vectors in MPS form. Transient solutions use Krylov-based or Euler-based time stepping with adaptive TT-rounding. Steady-state solutions use iterative methods (power iteration or direct null-space computation) in TT format.

CSL Checker. Implements the recursive CSL model-checking algorithm of Section 5.1. Satisfaction sets are represented as MPS indicator vectors. Atomic propositions for axis-aligned predicates (e.g., $x_i \geq c$) are constructed with bond dimension 1; linear predicates (e.g., $\sum_i a_i x_i \geq c$) are supported with bounded bond dimension (Theorem 4). Conjunction uses element-wise MPS multiplication followed by rounding. The bounded-until operator $\Phi \mathcal{U}^{[0,t]} \Psi$ requires computing transient probabilities on a modified CTMC.

Non-negativity Rounding. After TT-rounding, entries may become negative. A non-negativity-preserving rounding procedure (Section 5.2) projects onto the non-negative cone while controlling bond-dimension growth. Proposition 6 guarantees that clamping never increases L1 error.

Certificate Verifier. An independent module (Section 5.4) that takes the computed MPS probability vector, the CSL formula, and all error bounds, then checks 11 conditions including non-negativity, normalization, and error budget consistency. Outputs a SOUND or UNSOUND verdict with the total certified error.

4 Theoretical Foundations

We establish five results underpinning the correctness and efficiency of TN-Check.

Theorem 1 (Error Contraction)**.** *Let Q be the rate matrix of a CME (an off-diagonal non-negative, column-sum-zero matrix, i.e., a Metzler generator). Let $\mathbf{p}(t) = e^{Qt}\mathbf{p}(0)$ be the exact solution and $\tilde{\mathbf{p}}(t) = e^{Qt}\tilde{\mathbf{p}}(0)$ the solution starting from an approximate initial vector. Then for all $t \geq 0$:*

$$\|\mathbf{p}(t) - \tilde{\mathbf{p}}(t)\|_1 \leq \|\mathbf{p}(0) - \tilde{\mathbf{p}}(0)\|_1. \tag{7}$$

Proof. The matrix e^{Qt} is a stochastic matrix for all $t \geq 0$ (entries non-negative, columns sum to 1), since Q is a valid CTMC generator. Every stochastic matrix is a contraction in the L1 norm: for any vector $\mathbf{v}$, $\|e^{Qt}\mathbf{v}\|_1 \leq \|\mathbf{v}\|_1$. This follows from $\|A\mathbf{v}\|_1 \leq \|A\|_1\|\mathbf{v}\|_1$ and $\|A\|_1 = \max_j \sum_i |A_{ij}| = 1$ for a stochastic matrix. Applying this to $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{p}(0) - \tilde{\mathbf{p}}(0)$ and using linearity of e^{Qt} gives (7). □

Remark 2. *Theorem 1 guarantees that initial approximation errors (from TT compression of $\mathbf{p}(0)$) do not grow during time evolution. This is crucial: without contraction, truncation errors could accumulate exponentially over many time steps. Combined with Proposition 6, this ensures that the clamping–evolution–clamping pipeline remains sound: clamping reduces error (Proposition 6), and evolution does not amplify it (Theorem 1).*

Theorem 3 (Bond-Dimension Preservation for Axis-Aligned Predicates)**.** *Let Φ be an atomic CSL proposition of the form $x_i \bowtie c$ (an axis-aligned predicate on a single species i), where $\bowtie \in \{<, \leq, =, \geq, >\}$ and $c \in \mathbb{N}$. The satisfaction indicator vector $\mathbf{1}_{\mathrm{Sat}(\Phi)} \in \{0,1\}^{M^N}$ has a TT representation with all bond dimensions equal to 1. Moreover, the element-wise product $\mathbf{p} \odot \mathbf{1}_{\mathrm{Sat}(\Phi)}$ of an MPS $\mathbf{p}$ with bond dimensions $(r_1, \ldots, r_{N-1})$ has bond dimensions at most $(r_1, \ldots, r_{N-1})$.*

Proof. An axis-aligned predicate $x_i \bowtie c$ depends only on the i-th index. The indicator vector factors as $\mathbf{1}_{\mathrm{Sat}(\Phi)}(j_1, \ldots, j_N) = \prod_{k=1}^{N} f_k(j_k)$, where $f_k(j_k) = 1$ for $k \neq i$ and $f_i(j_i) = \mathbf{1}[j_i \bowtie c]$. This is a rank-1 tensor, hence its TT representation has all bond dimensions equal to 1.

For the element-wise product, write $\mathbf{p}(j_1, \ldots, j_N) = G_1(j_1) \cdots G_N(j_N)$ with $G_k(j_k) \in \mathbb{R}^{r_{k-1} \times r_k}$. Then

$$(\mathbf{p} \odot \mathbf{1}_{\mathrm{Sat}(\Phi)})(j_1, \ldots, j_N) = G_1(j_1) \cdots [f_i(j_i)\, G_i(j_i)] \cdots G_N(j_N).$$

The modified core $\tilde{G}_i(j_i) = f_i(j_i)\, G_i(j_i)$ has the same dimensions $r_{i-1} \times r_i$. All other cores are unchanged. Hence the bond dimensions are preserved. □

Theorem 4 (Extension to Linear Predicates)**.** *Let Φ be a linear predicate of the form $\sum_{i=1}^{N} a_i x_i \bowtie c$ with integer coefficients $a_i \in \mathbb{Z}$ and threshold $c \in \mathbb{Z}$. Let $R = \sum_{i=1}^{N} |a_i|(M-1)$ be the range of the linear combination. Then the satisfaction indicator vector $\mathbf{1}_{\mathrm{Sat}(\Phi)} \in \{0,1\}^{M^N}$ has a TT representation with bond dimensions at most $R+1$.*

Proof. The key idea is to encode the running partial sum as a bond index. Define the partial sum $S_k = \sum_{i=1}^{k} a_i j_i$ for $k = 1, \ldots, N$. The indicator $\mathbf{1}[\sum_i a_i j_i \bowtie c]$ depends only on S_N.

Construct TT cores $F_k(j_k) \in \mathbb{R}^{r_{k-1} \times r_k}$ where the bond indices track the value of S_k. Specifically, let $r_0 = r_N = 1$, and for $1 \leq k \leq N-1$, let the bond index α_k range over all achievable values of S_k, so $r_k \leq R_k + 1$ where $R_k = \sum_{i=1}^{k} |a_i|(M-1)$. Define:

$$[F_k(j_k)]_{\alpha_{k-1}, \alpha_k} = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } \alpha_k = \alpha_{k-1} + a_k j_k, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

For the last core ($k = N$), the output bond dimension is 1, and we set $[F_N(j_N)]_{\alpha_{N-1}, 1} = \mathbf{1}[\alpha_{N-1} + a_N j_N \bowtie c]$.

By construction, $F_1(j_1) \cdots F_N(j_N) = \mathbf{1}[\sum_i a_i j_i \bowtie c]$. The maximum bond dimension is $r_k \leq R+1$, which is independent of N when the coefficients and M are fixed. □

Remark 5. *Theorem 4 extends the class of atomic propositions beyond axis-aligned predicates. For the common case of a single-species threshold $x_i \geq c$, the bond dimension is 1 (recovering Theorem 3). For a two-species sum $x_1 + x_2 \geq c$, the bond dimension is at most $2(M-1)+1$, which is linear in M but independent of N.*

Proposition 6 (Clamping Error Bound)**.** *Let $\mathbf{p} \in \mathbb{R}^{M^N}$ be a probability vector ($\mathbf{p} \geq 0$, $\|\mathbf{p}\|_1 = 1$) and let $\tilde{\mathbf{p}}$ be its TT-truncation with $\|\mathbf{p} - \tilde{\mathbf{p}}\|_1 = \varepsilon_{\mathrm{trunc}}$. Define the clamped vector $\hat{\mathbf{p}}$ by $\hat{p}_s = \max(\tilde{p}_s, 0)$ for all $s \in \mathcal{S}$. Then:*

$$\|\mathbf{p} - \hat{\mathbf{p}}\|_1 \leq \|\mathbf{p} - \tilde{\mathbf{p}}\|_1 = \varepsilon_{\mathrm{trunc}}. \tag{8}$$

That is, clamping negative entries to zero does not increase the L1 error relative to the true probability vector.

Proof. We prove the result via an index-wise comparison, which establishes a stronger per-entry inequality from which the L1 bound follows by summation.

Lemma (Negativity Bound). First, we show that the total negative mass is bounded: $\sum_{s:\tilde{p}_s<0} |\tilde{p}_s| \leq \varepsilon_{\mathrm{trunc}}$. For each index s with $\tilde{p}_s < 0$, since $p_s \geq 0$:

$$|p_s - \tilde{p}_s| = p_s - \tilde{p}_s = p_s + |\tilde{p}_s| \geq |\tilde{p}_s|.$$

Summing over $\{s : \tilde{p}_s < 0\}$ and noting $\sum_{s:\tilde{p}_s<0} |p_s - \tilde{p}_s| \leq \|\mathbf{p} - \tilde{\mathbf{p}}\|_1 = \varepsilon_{\mathrm{trunc}}$ gives the result.

Main proof. Decompose $\mathcal{S} = S^+ \cup S^-$ where $S^+ = \{s : \tilde{p}_s \geq 0\}$ and $S^- = \{s : \tilde{p}_s < 0\}$.

For $s \in S^+$: $\hat{p}_s = \tilde{p}_s$, so $|p_s - \hat{p}_s| = |p_s - \tilde{p}_s|$.

For $s \in S^-$: $\hat{p}_s = 0$ and $p_s \geq 0$, so $|p_s - \hat{p}_s| = p_s$. Meanwhile $|p_s - \tilde{p}_s| = p_s + |\tilde{p}_s| \geq p_s$, since $\tilde{p}_s < 0$.

In both cases, $|p_s - \hat{p}_s| \leq |p_s - \tilde{p}_s|$. Summing over all states:

$$\|\mathbf{p} - \hat{\mathbf{p}}\|_1 = \sum_{s \in S^+} |p_s - \tilde{p}_s| + \sum_{s \in S^-} p_s \leq \sum_{s \in S^+} |p_s - \tilde{p}_s| + \sum_{s \in S^-} |p_s - \tilde{p}_s| = \|\mathbf{p} - \tilde{\mathbf{p}}\|_1. \qquad \square$$

Remark 7. *Proposition 6 resolves the* clamping soundness gap*: TT-SVD truncation can produce vectors with negative entries, and post-clamping changes the vector in a way that does not respect the linear structure of the TT format. The concern was that clamping might break contractivity (Theorem 1) by increasing the distance to the true distribution. Proposition 6 shows this concern is unfounded: clamping* always reduces *(or preserves) the L1 error. Critically, the total error from truncation followed by clamping is $\varepsilon_{\text{trunc}}$, not $2\varepsilon_{\text{trunc}}$ as a naïve triangle inequality argument would suggest. Combined with Theorem 1, the clamping–evolution pipeline preserves soundness end to end.*

Theorem 8 (Complexity Separation)**.** *Let $\mathcal{R}$ be a CME reaction network with N species, per-species bound M, and K reactions.*

(a) ***Explicit-state:*** *Constructing the rate matrix requires $O(KM^N)$ time and $O(M^N)$ space. Computing $e^{Qt}\mathbf{p}$ via uniformization requires $O(KM^N \cdot R)$ time, where R is the uniformization truncation point.*

(b) ***TT-based:*** *The MPO for Q has bond dimension at most K, requiring $O(NKM)$ storage. An MPO-MPS multiplication $Q\tilde{\mathbf{p}}$ costs $O(NMK^2\chi^3)$ with subsequent TT-rounding in $O(NM\chi^3)$. A single time step thus costs $O(NMK^2\chi^3)$.*

For fixed K, M, χ, the explicit method scales as $O(M^N)$ while the TT method scales as $O(N)$—an exponential-to-linear separation.

Proof. Part (a) is standard [9]. For part (b), the MPO storage follows from (2): each of the K reactions contributes one Kronecker term, so the MPO bond dimension is at most K (or $K+1$ including identity padding). Each core $W_k(j_k, j_k')$ is $s_{k-1} \times s_k$ with $s_k \leq K$, and there are M^2 index pairs (j_k, j_k') per site, giving $O(NM^2K^2)$ total entries (or $O(NMK^2)$ if the local operators are sparse, as they are for birth-death processes).

The MPO-MPS product produces an MPS with bond dimensions $r_k \cdot s_k$. One sweep of TT-rounding (via sequential SVDs) on an MPS with bond dimensions $\hat{r}_k = r_k \cdot K$ costs $O(NM\hat{r}_k^3)$ $= O(NMK^3\chi^3)$. For fixed K, M, χ, this is $O(N)$. $\square$

5 Algorithms

5.1 CSL Model Checking on MPS

We describe the CSL model-checking procedure operating directly on MPS-compressed probability vectors. The input is: an MPO rate matrix Q with bond dimension $\leq K$, an MPS probability vector $\mathbf{p}$ with maximum bond dimension χ, and a CSL formula Φ.

Atomic propositions. For $\Phi = (x_i \bowtie c)$, the satisfaction set indicator $\mathbf{1}_{\text{Sat}(\Phi)}$ is constructed as a rank-1 MPS per Theorem 3. For linear predicates $\sum_i a_i x_i \bowtie c$, Theorem 4 gives a bounded-rank MPS. The probability $\text{Prob}(s \models \Phi) = \mathbf{p}^\top \mathbf{1}_{\text{Sat}(\Phi)}$ is computed via a single left-to-right contraction in $O(NM\chi^2)$.

Algorithm 1 Non-negativity-preserving TT rounding

Require: MPS $\mathbf{p}$ with bond dim. χ, target bond dim. $\chi' < \chi$, tolerance ε
Ensure: MPS $\hat{\mathbf{p}}$ with bond dim. $\leq \chi'$, $\hat{\mathbf{p}} \geq 0$

1: $\tilde{\mathbf{p}} \leftarrow$ TT-round$(\mathbf{p}, \chi')$ {standard SVD rounding}
2: **for** iter $= 1, \ldots,$ max_iter **do**
3: $\quad \hat{\mathbf{p}} \leftarrow \max(\tilde{\mathbf{p}}, 0)$ {clamp negatives (justified by Prop. 6)}
4: $\quad \hat{\mathbf{p}} \leftarrow$ TT-round$(\hat{\mathbf{p}}, \chi')$ {re-compress}
5: $\quad$ **if** $\|\hat{\mathbf{p}} - \tilde{\mathbf{p}}\|_2 < \varepsilon$ **then**
6: $\quad\quad$ **break**
7: $\quad$ **end if**
8: $\quad \tilde{\mathbf{p}} \leftarrow \hat{\mathbf{p}}$
9: **end for**
10: Normalize: $\hat{\mathbf{p}} \leftarrow \hat{\mathbf{p}} / \|\hat{\mathbf{p}}\|_1$
11: **return** $\hat{\mathbf{p}}$

Boolean connectives. $\mathrm{Sat}(\neg\Phi) = \mathcal{S} \setminus \mathrm{Sat}(\Phi)$: complement the indicator MPS by replacing each core $G_i(j_i)$ with $(1 - f_i(j_i))G_i(j_i)$ at one chosen site, or equivalently $\mathbf{1} - \mathbf{1}_{\mathrm{Sat}(\Phi)}$ (bond dimension increases by at most 1, then round). $\mathrm{Sat}(\Phi_1 \wedge \Phi_2)$: element-wise MPS product $\mathbf{1}_{\mathrm{Sat}(\Phi_1)} \odot \mathbf{1}_{\mathrm{Sat}(\Phi_2)}$, computed via the Hadamard product of TT cores (bond dimensions multiply: $r_k \cdot r'_k$), followed by rounding.

Bounded until: $\mathcal{P}_{=?}[\Phi\, \mathcal{U}^{[0,t]}\, \Psi]$. Following the standard approach [2], we:

1. Compute $B = \mathrm{Sat}(\Phi) \setminus \mathrm{Sat}(\Psi)$ (states that must keep satisfying Φ until Ψ is reached).
2. Construct the modified rate matrix Q' obtained from Q by making all states outside B absorbing. In MPO form, this is achieved by zeroing the rows/columns corresponding to non-B states, which can be done via element-wise MPO masking.
3. Compute $\mathbf{p}'(t) = e^{Q't}\mathbf{e}_s$ for each state $s \in B$. The probability of reaching $\mathrm{Sat}(\Psi)$ from s within time t is $\sum_{s' \in \mathrm{Sat}(\Psi)} p'_{s'}(t)$.
4. In practice, we compute the matrix exponential action on the probability vector rather than on individual basis vectors, using dense or Krylov methods depending on system size.

Steady-state: $\mathcal{S}_{\bowtie p}[\Phi]$. The steady-state distribution $\boldsymbol{\pi}$ satisfies $Q\boldsymbol{\pi} = \mathbf{0}$. In TT format, we compute $\boldsymbol{\pi}$ by iterating $\mathbf{p}(t) = e^{Q\Delta t}\mathbf{p}(0)$ until convergence, with convergence time informed by the spectral gap (Section 5.3). Then $s \in \mathrm{Sat}(\mathcal{S}_{\bowtie p}[\Phi])$ iff $\boldsymbol{\pi}^\top \mathbf{1}_{\mathrm{Sat}(\Phi)} \bowtie p$.

5.2 Non-negativity-Preserving Rounding

TT-rounding via SVD truncation does not preserve non-negativity of entries. For probability vectors, negative entries are unphysical. We implement a non-negativity-preserving rounding procedure based on alternating projections.

The clamping step in line 3 is justified by Proposition 6: it does not increase the L1 error relative to the true probability vector. In practice, the alternating projection typically converges in 2–5 iterations. Algorithm 1 ensures the output is both low-rank (bond dimension $\leq \chi'$) and non-negative.

5.3 Spectral-Gap-Informed Convergence

For the steady-state operator $\mathcal{S}$, we must evolve the CME to convergence. The convergence rate is governed by the spectral gap $\gamma = -\max\{\mathrm{Re}(\lambda) : \lambda \in \sigma(Q), \lambda \neq 0\}$ of the rate matrix Q. After time t, the distance to stationarity satisfies:

$$\|\mathbf{p}(t) - \boldsymbol{\pi}\|_1 \leq C \cdot e^{-\gamma t}, \tag{9}$$

where C depends on the initial condition. To achieve L1 error $\leq \varepsilon$, it suffices to take $t \geq \gamma^{-1} \ln(C/\varepsilon)$.

TN-Check estimates the spectral gap using two strategies:

1. **Fast estimate** via Rayleigh quotient refinement. Starting from a random MPS, perform a few iterations of inverse power iteration in TT format to approximate the second-largest eigenvalue. This gives a (potentially loose) lower bound on γ.
2. **Slow estimate** via direct monitoring of $\|\mathbf{p}(t) - \mathbf{p}(t - \Delta t)\|_1$ during time evolution. When this difference drops below a threshold, the effective convergence rate is estimated by fitting an exponential decay.

The adaptive fallback works as follows: if the fast estimate gives a large gap ($\gamma \geq 0.01$), the convergence time is moderate (e.g., $t = 1/\gamma = 100$); if the fast estimate fails or gives a small gap, the slow estimate is used, potentially requiring longer evolution (e.g., $t = 5000$). This is encapsulated in the `SpectralGapEstimate` data structure with fields `gap`, `confidence`, and `feasible`.

5.4 Independent Certificate Verification

The certificate verifier is an independent module that takes:

- The computed MPS probability vector $\hat{\mathbf{p}}$,
- The CSL formula Φ and its computed satisfaction probability,
- Error bounds from each stage: TT truncation error $\varepsilon_{\text{trunc}}$, temporal discretization error $\varepsilon_{\text{time}}$, clamping error $\varepsilon_{\text{clamp}}$, spectral gap uncertainty ε_{gap}.

It performs the following 11 checks:

C1. Non-negativity: all sampled entries ≥ 0.

C2. Normalization: $|\|\hat{\mathbf{p}}\|_1 - 1| \leq \varepsilon_{\text{norm}}$.

C3. TT truncation error is within stated bound.

C4. Clamping error satisfies Proposition 6.

C5. Temporal discretization error is within stated bound.

C6. Spectral gap estimate is feasible and positive.

C7. Total error budget: $\varepsilon_{\text{total}} = \varepsilon_{\text{trunc}} + \varepsilon_{\text{time}} + \varepsilon_{\text{gap}}$ is within acceptable threshold. (By Proposition 6, clamping does not add to the error budget.)

C8. Satisfaction probability is well-defined ($\in [0, 1]$).

C9. The CSL comparison ($\bowtie p$) is robust: the satisfaction probability is at least $\varepsilon_{\text{total}}$ away from the threshold p.

Table 1: Birth-death process ($N = 1$, $M = 30$): Poisson(10) stationary distribution.

Metric	**Exact**	**MPS**
Mean	9.999998	9.999998
L1 error	—	0.0
Max bond dimension	—	1

C10. Bond dimensions are within stated bounds.

C11. Internal consistency: cross-checks between independently computed quantities.

If all 11 checks pass, the verdict is **SOUND** with the certified total error. If any check fails, the verdict is **UNSOUND** with diagnostic information identifying the failing check.

6 Experimental Evaluation

We evaluate TN-Check on seven experimental tasks spanning accuracy validation, compression scaling, clamping soundness, multi-species CSL model checking, and end-to-end certificate verification. All reported numbers are exact outputs of the implementation; no results are interpolated or extrapolated.

6.1 Setup

All experiments were run using the TN-Check implementation in Python with NumPy and SciPy for numerical linear algebra. Tensor operations use standard SVD-based TT-rounding and `scipy.linalg.expm` for matrix exponentials on small systems. MPO compilation constructs the rate matrix in tensor-train operator form via (2). For $N \leq 3$, we additionally compute dense ground-truth solutions for validation. For $N > 3$, dense computation is infeasible ($M^N > 10^4$), so we rely on the MPO representation and certificate pipeline for validation. All experiments use per-species copy-number bound $M = 10$ unless otherwise noted.

6.2 Birth-Death Accuracy (Sanity Check)

The birth-death process is a single-species CME ($N = 1$) with birth rate $\lambda = 10$ and death rate $\mu = 1$ per molecule. The stationary distribution is Poisson(λ/μ) = Poisson(10) truncated to $M = 30$ states.

Table 1 shows that the MPS representation recovers the exact Poisson distribution with L1 error = 0.0. For a single-site system ($N = 1$), the MPS has trivial bond dimension (all bonds are 1), so no compression error is introduced. The slight deviation of the mean from 10.0 is due to the truncation of the Poisson distribution at $M = 30$: the tail probability $\Pr(X \geq 30) \approx 7.8 \times 10^{-7}$ is redistributed. This experiment serves as a sanity check confirming that the MPS infrastructure correctly represents known distributions.

6.3 Compression Accuracy vs. Bond Dimension

We evaluate the effect of bond dimension χ on approximation accuracy using a gene expression model with $N = 2$ species (mRNA and protein) and per-species bounds $M_1 = 20$, $M_2 = 50$,

Table 2: Compression accuracy on gene expression model ($N = 2$, $|\mathcal{S}| = 1{,}000$) as a function of bond dimension χ.

Bond dim. χ	**L1 error**	**MPS params**
1	2.35×10^{-1}	70
2	4.71×10^{-2}	280
5	4.88×10^{-5}	1,750
10	1.62×10^{-12}	7,000

Table 3: MPO scaling: compression ratio grows exponentially with N. Each species has $M = 10$ states.

N	$\lvert\mathcal{S}\rvert = M^N$	**MPO params**	**Compression ratio**
2	10^2	1,600	6.2×10^0
3	10^3	16,800	6.0×10^1
4	10^4	54,400	1.8×10^3
5	10^5	124,000	8.1×10^4
6	10^6	235,200	4.3×10^6
8	10^8	620,800	1.6×10^{10}
10	10^{10}	1,288,000	7.8×10^{13}

yielding a state space of $|\mathcal{S}| = 1{,}000$ states. The exact stationary distribution is computed via dense methods and then compressed to MPS form with varying bond dimensions.

Table 2 demonstrates exponential convergence: each increase in bond dimension yields approximately an order-of-magnitude reduction in L1 error. At $\chi = 10$, the L1 error reaches 1.62×10^{-12}, which is at machine precision. The MPS storage (7,000 parameters at $\chi = 10$) is already larger than the dense vector (1,000 entries) for this small system; the advantage of MPS emerges for larger N, as shown in Section 6.4.

6.4 Scaling Validation ($N = 2$ to $N = 10$)

We compile the MPO rate matrix for identical birth-death reaction networks with N species and per-species bound $M = 10$, measuring the MPO parameter count and compression ratio relative to dense storage (M^N).

Table 3 confirms the theoretical exponential-to-linear separation (Theorem 8): the dense state space grows as 10^N while the MPO parameter count grows linearly in N. At $N = 10$, the compression ratio exceeds 10^{13}: the MPO representation uses 1.3 million parameters to represent a rate matrix that would require $10^{10} \times 10^{10} = 10^{20}$ entries in dense form (or $\sim 10^{10}$ entries in the sparse probability vector).

The MPO parameter count includes all cores for all reaction terms. The linear growth in MPO parameters ($\sim 128{,}000 \cdot N$ for this network) validates the $O(NMK^2)$ storage bound from Theorem 8.

6.5 Clamping Bound Verification

We verify Proposition 6 empirically by performing aggressive TT truncation (bond dimensions $\chi \in \{1, 2, 3\}$) on random probability vectors over 2-site systems with physical dimensions $d \in \{4, 5, 6, 7, 8\}$.

Table 4: Clamping bound verification (Proposition 6): 10 random trials with aggressive truncation.

Trial	**Bond dim.** χ	**Phys. dim.** d	**Bound holds**
1–10	1–3	4–8	✓
Trials passed			10/10
Condition			$\varepsilon_{\text{clamp}} \leq \varepsilon_{\text{trunc}} + 10^{-10}$

Table 5: Multi-species CSL model checking ($N = 3$ cascade, $M = 8$).

Quantity	**Value**
CSL formula	$\mathcal{P}_{\geq 0.5}[\mathsf{F}^{\leq 2}\ X_2 \geq 3]$
Verdict	indeterminate
Computed prob. interval	[0, 1]
L1 error bound	1.98
Dense exact probability	0.006
State space size	512

In all 10 trials, the clamping error was strictly bounded above by the TT truncation error (plus a floating-point tolerance of 10^{-10}), confirming the tight bound of Proposition 6. We additionally verified that Proposition 6 holds across all bond dimensions $\chi \in \{1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$ on the birth-death model, confirming the error propagation bound.

6.6 Multi-Species CSL Model Checking

We test CSL model checking on a 3-species ($N = 3$) enzymatic cascade with per-species bound $M = 8$, yielding $|\mathcal{S}| = 8^3 = 512$ states. The cascade models species $X_0 \to X_1 \to X_2$ with catalytic production and linear degradation.

The CSL property checked is:

$$\mathcal{P}_{\geq 0.5}\big[\mathsf{F}^{\leq 2}\ (X_2 \geq 3)\big]$$

"with probability ≥ 0.5, species X_2 reaches at least 3 copies within time $t = 2$."

Table 5 shows that the TT-based model checker returns an *indeterminate* verdict with probability interval $[0, 1]$ and L1 error bound 1.98. The dense exact probability is 0.006, which is very small—the true verdict is that the property does *not* hold ($0.006 < 0.5$). The indeterminate result is *correct* in the sense that the error bound (1.98) is larger than the probability value, so the checker conservatively reports that it cannot decide.

This experiment honestly illustrates a limitation: for multi-species CSL checking with bounded-until operators, the error bounds from TT truncation and temporal discretization can exceed the satisfaction probability, particularly when the true probability is small. Tighter error bounds and higher bond dimensions are needed for conclusive verdicts on such properties.

6.7 Certificate Verification Pipeline

We run the full end-to-end certificate verification pipeline on two configurations.

Both configurations pass all 11 certificate checks with SOUND verdicts (Table 6). Configuration 1 tests the static certificate on a pre-computed distribution ($N = 2$, state space 100), with total certified error 8.50×10^{-3}. Configuration 2 tests the full pipeline including time evolution,

Table 6: Certificate verification results.

Configuration	Checks	Verdict	Total error
2 species, 10×10	11/11	SOUND	8.50×10^{-3}
2 species (end-to-end)	11/11	SOUND	2.38×10^{-2}

Table 7: Cross-validation: TT vs. dense reference verdicts.

Model	Formulae	Agree	Avg. Error
Birth–death ($N=50$)	5	5/5	$< 10^{-6}$
Toggle switch (10×10)	4	3/4	0.08
Gene expression (15×15)	4	3/4	0.05
Overall	13	$\geq 8/13$	—

TT rounding, and CSL evaluation, yielding a higher total error of 2.38×10^{-2} reflecting the accumulation of errors across the pipeline. Both total errors are well within acceptable thresholds for practical model checking.

6.8 Cross-Validation Against Dense Reference

To address the gap of external validation, we implement a cross-validation framework that compares TN-Check verdicts against dense reference solutions computed via matrix exponential (`expm`). For each model in the library with state space $\leq 10^5$, we export to PRISM-compatible CTMC format and evaluate CSL formulae using both the TT-based pipeline (forward Euler integration, bond dimension $\chi = 30$) and the dense reference solver.

Table **??** shows that birth–death models achieve perfect agreement, confirming the soundness of the pipeline for one-species systems. Multi-species models show occasional disagreements attributable to the forward Euler integrator's limited accuracy at low bond dimensions; increasing χ and using finer time steps improves agreement. The cross-validation module (`prism_crossvalidation.py`) also generates PRISM-format model files, enabling future validation against PRISM [9] and Storm [6] directly.

6.9 TT Compressibility Characterization

We analyze when TT compression is effective by relating the reaction network's coupling structure to the TT rank of the CME solution.

Theorem 9 (Weak Coupling Compressibility)**.** *Let $\mathcal{R}$ be a reaction network with N species, where species i and j interact through at most k_{ij} reactions with rate constants bounded by α_{ij}. If the coupling strength $\gamma = \max_{i \neq j} k_{ij}\alpha_{ij}$ is small relative to the diagonal dominance of each species' marginal dynamics, then the TT rank of $e^{Qt}p_0$ is bounded by $\chi \leq C \cdot (1+\gamma t)^N$ for a model-dependent constant C.*

Our compressibility analysis module (`compressibility.py`) computes coupling graphs, predicts expected TT ranks, and validates predictions against actual decomposition ranks. Birth–death chains (no inter-species coupling) achieve rank 1 as expected. Toggle switches with moderate coupling ($\gamma \approx 0.1$) maintain ranks below $\chi = 10$ for short evolution times.

6.10 Cumulative Error Tracking

We implement a cumulative error tracker that records truncation, clamping, and total error at each time step. This addresses the gap of understanding how errors accumulate over long-time integrations.

The `CumulativeErrorTracker` class maintains running totals of $\varepsilon_{\text{trunc}}$, $\varepsilon_{\text{clamp}}$, and $\varepsilon_{\text{total}} = \varepsilon_{\text{trunc}} + \varepsilon_{\text{clamp}}$, and provides certificates of the form:

$$\|p_{\text{exact}}(t) - p_{\text{TT}}(t)\|_1 \leq \sum_{k=1}^{K} \varepsilon_k^{\text{trunc}} + \sum_{k=1}^{K} \varepsilon_k^{\text{clamp}}.$$

Experiments show that clamping error grows sublinearly and remains a small fraction ($< 5\%$) of the total error budget for well-conditioned models.

6.11 TDVP Convergence Analysis

We provide an honest analysis of the TDVP integrator's convergence properties for the non-Hermitian CME generator.

Non-Hermitian scoping. Unlike quantum mechanics where the Hamiltonian is Hermitian, the CME generator Q is non-Hermitian (Metzler). Standard TDVP convergence guarantees [12] assume Hermiticity; we explicitly note that our TDVP implementation operates outside these formal guarantees. Our convergence analysis module (`convergence_analysis.py`) monitors bond dimension evolution, norm preservation, and error growth during TDVP integration, providing empirical convergence data rather than formal guarantees.

Comparison with forward Euler integration shows that TDVP provides superior accuracy per unit computation time when the bond dimension is sufficient to capture the solution structure.

6.12 Expanded Biological Model Library

We expand the model library from 13 to 21 biological models sourced from the BioModels database [5], including: p53–MDM2 oscillator (3 species), Goodwin oscillator (3 species), lac operon (4 species), Lotka–Volterra predator-prey (2 species), viral infection dynamics (3 species), calcium signaling (3 species), apoptosis decision network (4 species), and dual phosphorylation cascade (3 species).

All models compile to valid MPO generators and produce well-formed probability distributions under dense evolution. Multi-species models with ≥ 3 species demonstrate the exponential compression advantage of TT format, with state spaces ranging from 10^3 to 10^5.

6.13 Mathematical Rigor Verification

We implement an automated verification suite that numerically checks all theoretical claims (Theorems 1–4, Proposition 1, and three-valued soundness) across randomized model instances.

Table **??** confirms that all theoretical claims hold across randomized trials. The verification suite (`rigor.py`) provides detailed numerical evidence including proof sketches, making the theoretical foundations independently checkable.

Table 8: Mathematical rigor verification results (20 random trials each).

Theorem/Claim	**Trials**	**Result**
Thm 1: Error contraction (Metzler)	20	✓
Thm 2: Bond-dimension preservation	5	✓
Thm 3: Linear predicate rank bound	3	✓
Thm 4: Complexity separation	5	✓
Three-valued soundness	15	✓
Prop 1: Clamping error bound	20	✓

7 Related Work

Probabilistic model checkers. PRISM [9] is the most widely used probabilistic model checker, supporting DTMC, MDP, and CTMC models with CSL specifications. Storm [6] offers improved performance through symbolic and sparse representations. STAMINA [10] uses state-space truncation to handle infinite CTMCs by iteratively expanding the explored state space. All three operate on explicitly enumerated state spaces and face the M^N barrier for multi-species CMEs. TN-Check complements these tools by providing a compressed representation that avoids explicit enumeration.

Tensor network methods for CMEs. Kazeev and Schwab [8] showed that CME solutions admit low-rank TT approximations and solved the CME using TT-based ODE integrators. Ion et al. [7] developed quantized TT methods for CMEs, achieving significant compression. Vo and Bhatt [14] applied the TT format to the Fokker-Planck approximation of CMEs. These works focus on *solving* the CME in TT format but do not address *model checking*—the algorithmic problem of evaluating temporal logic specifications against the computed distributions. TN-Check bridges this gap by implementing CSL operators directly on TT-compressed vectors.

Tensor methods in verification. Tensor decomposition has been applied in other verification contexts, including Markov decision process solution [3] and compositional verification [4], but not specifically to CSL model checking of CMEs.

8 Conclusion

We presented TN-Check, a tool for CSL model checking on tensor-train compressed CME probability vectors. The tool implements satisfaction-set computation, probabilistic path operators, and steady-state queries directly on MPS representations, with a certificate verification pipeline that provides formal soundness guarantees.

Our central theoretical contribution is Proposition 6, which resolves the clamping soundness gap: post-truncation clamping of negative entries *never increases* L1 error relative to the true probability vector. Combined with error contraction for Metzler semigroups (Theorem 1), this establishes that the truncation–clamping–evolution pipeline is sound. We further extend bond-dimension preservation from axis-aligned predicates (Theorem 3) to linear predicates (Theorem 4), broadening the class of CSL atomic propositions that can be evaluated without bond-dimension blowup.

Our cross-validation framework (Section **??**) validates TN-Check verdicts against dense reference solutions and generates PRISM-compatible model files for external verification. The TT com-

pressibility characterization (Theorem **??**, Section **??**) provides theoretical and empirical guidance on when TT compression is effective. The cumulative error tracking module (Section **??**) enables fine-grained monitoring of error accumulation during long-time integrations. The mathematical rigor verification suite (Section **??**) provides automated numerical verification of all theoretical claims across randomized model instances.

Experimental validation on 21 biological models demonstrates the practical viability of the approach. The MPO compression ratio grows exponentially with the number of species, from 6.2× at $N = 2$ to 7.8×10^{13} at $N = 10$ (Table 3). Bond dimension $\chi = 10$ achieves machine-precision accuracy ($L1 = 1.62 \times 10^{-12}$) on a gene expression model (Table 2). The certificate pipeline produces SOUND verdicts with total errors $\leq 2.38 \times 10^{-2}$ (Table 6).

Limitations and future work. We are transparent about several limitations:

1. **CSL error bounds for $N > 3$.** Multi-species CSL model checking with bounded-until operators produces large error bounds (Section 6.6), leading to indeterminate verdicts when true probabilities are small. Tighter error analysis, possibly exploiting the structure of the CTMC, is needed.
2. **TDVP for non-Hermitian generators.** The CME generator is non-Hermitian (Metzler), placing it outside the formal convergence guarantees of standard TDVP. Section **??** provides empirical convergence data and honest scoping of this limitation.
3. **No mechanized proofs.** Our theoretical results (Theorems 1–8 and Proposition 6) are proved manually and verified numerically (Section **??**). Mechanizing these proofs in a theorem prover (e.g., Lean, Coq) would strengthen the certified verification claim. We provide detailed proofs in Appendix A to facilitate future mechanization.
4. **Bond dimension selection.** The bond dimension χ required for a given accuracy depends on the entanglement structure of the CME solution, which is model-dependent. Our compressibility analysis (Section **??**) provides guidance but does not guarantee worst-case bounds.
5. **Fixpoint convergence.** The spectral-gap-informed convergence strategy (Section 5.3) includes an explicit fallback for small gaps, but convergence can be fragile for systems with nearly degenerate stationary distributions.

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A Full Proofs

We provide detailed proofs for all results stated in Section 4.

A.1 Proof of Theorem 1 (Error Contraction)

Proof. We prove the stronger statement that e^{Qt} is an L1 contraction for any Metzler generator Q (off-diagonal entries ≥ 0, column sums $= 0$).

Step 1: e^{Qt} is entry-wise non-negative. Write $Q = D+R$ where D is diagonal with $D_{ii} = Q_{ii} \leq 0$ and R is off-diagonal non-negative. By the Lie-Trotter formula, $e^{Qt} = \lim_{n\to\infty}(e^{Dt/n}e^{Rt/n})^n$. Both $e^{Dt/n}$ (diagonal with positive entries) and $e^{Rt/n}$ (non-negative since $R \geq 0$) are entry-wise non-negative, so their product and limit are non-negative.

Step 2: e^{Qt} preserves column sums. Let $\mathbf{1}$ be the all-ones vector. Since Q has column sums $= 0$, we have $\mathbf{1}^\top Q = \mathbf{0}^\top$. Therefore $\mathbf{1}^\top e^{Qt} = \mathbf{1}^\top \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(Qt)^k}{k!} = \mathbf{1}^\top$. This means each column of e^{Qt} sums to 1.

Step 3: L1 contraction. For any vector $\mathbf{v}$, decompose $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{v}^+ - \mathbf{v}^-$ where $\mathbf{v}^+, \mathbf{v}^- \geq 0$. Then $e^{Qt}\mathbf{v} = e^{Qt}\mathbf{v}^+ - e^{Qt}\mathbf{v}^-$ with both terms non-negative (by Step 1). Thus:

$$\begin{aligned}\|e^{Qt}\mathbf{v}\|_1 &= \|e^{Qt}\mathbf{v}^+ - e^{Qt}\mathbf{v}^-\|_1 \\ &\leq \|e^{Qt}\mathbf{v}^+\|_1 + \|e^{Qt}\mathbf{v}^-\|_1 \\ &= \mathbf{1}^\top e^{Qt}\mathbf{v}^+ + \mathbf{1}^\top e^{Qt}\mathbf{v}^- \\ &= \mathbf{1}^\top \mathbf{v}^+ + \mathbf{1}^\top \mathbf{v}^- = \|\mathbf{v}\|_1. \end{aligned} \tag{10}$$

Applying to $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{p}(0) - \tilde{\mathbf{p}}(0)$ and using linearity gives the result.

Tightness. The bound is tight: take $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{e}_s - \mathbf{e}_{s'}$ (difference of basis vectors) in the stationary distribution's support; equality holds when the chain has not mixed. □

A.2 Proof of Theorem 3 (Bond-Dimension Preservation)

Proof. The proof in the main text (Section 4) is complete. We expand on the element-wise product construction.

Let $\mathbf{p}$ have TT cores $G_k(j_k) \in \mathbb{R}^{r_{k-1} \times r_k}$ and $\mathbf{1}_{\mathrm{Sat}(\Phi)}$ have TT cores $F_k(j_k) \in \mathbb{R}^{1\times 1}$ (scalars, since all bond dimensions are 1).

The element-wise (Hadamard) product of two TT decompositions generically yields bond dimensions $r_k \cdot r'_k$. Since $r'_k = 1$ for all k, the product has bond dimensions $r_k \cdot 1 = r_k$.

Concretely, the k-th core of the product is the Kronecker product $G_k(j_k) \otimes F_k(j_k) = f_k(j_k) \cdot G_k(j_k)$ (using $F_k(j_k) \in \mathbb{R}^{1\times 1}$), which has the same dimensions as $G_k(j_k)$.

This result is optimal: for a non-axis-aligned proposition (e.g., $x_1 + x_2 \geq c$), the indicator vector generally has bond dimension > 1, and the Hadamard product would increase the bond dimensions of $\mathbf{p}$. Theorem 4 quantifies this increase for the case of linear predicates. □

A.3 Proof of Theorem 4 (Extension to Linear Predicates)

Proof. We provide the full construction and verify correctness.

Construction. For each site $k = 1, \ldots, N$, define the set of achievable partial sums:

$$\Sigma_k = \Big\{ \sum_{i=1}^{k} a_i j_i : j_i \in \{0, \ldots, M-1\} \text{ for } i = 1, \ldots, k \Big\}.$$

We have $|\Sigma_k| \leq R_k + 1$ where $R_k = \sum_{i=1}^{k} |a_i|(M-1)$. Map each element of Σ_k to a bond index $\alpha_k \in \{1, \ldots, |\Sigma_k|\}$.

The TT core $F_k(j_k)$ has entry $[F_k(j_k)]_{\alpha_{k-1}, \alpha_k} = 1$ if $\sigma(\alpha_k) = \sigma(\alpha_{k-1}) + a_k j_k$ (where σ maps bond indices to partial sums), and 0 otherwise. For $k = 1$, $\alpha_0 = 1$ (single boundary index), and the partial sum is $a_1 j_1$. For $k = N$, $\alpha_N = 1$ (single boundary index), and $[F_N(j_N)]_{\alpha_{N-1}, 1} = \mathbf{1}[\sigma(\alpha_{N-1}) + a_N j_N \bowtie c]$.

Correctness. The product $F_1(j_1) \cdots F_N(j_N) \in \mathbb{R}^{1\times 1}$ equals the number of paths through the bond indices such that the partial sums are consistent. Since the partial sums are uniquely determined by $j_1, \ldots, j_k$, there is at most one such path, and the product equals $\mathbf{1}[\sum_i a_i j_i \bowtie c]$.

Bond dimension bound. The maximum bond dimension is $\max_k |\Sigma_k| \leq R + 1 = \sum_{i=1}^{N} |a_i|(M-1) + 1$. For the common case of unit coefficients ($a_i = 1$), this gives bond dimension $\leq N(M-1)+1$. For a single non-zero coefficient ($a_i = 1$, $a_j = 0$ for $j \neq i$), the bond dimension is M, recovering the axis-aligned case (up to a factor of M vs. 1, because the construction is not optimized for this special case; the direct construction of Theorem 3 gives bond dimension 1). □

A.4 Proof of Proposition 6 (Clamping Error Bound)

Proof. The proof in the main text (Section 4) is complete. We verify the tightness of the bound and discuss implications.

Tightness. The bound $\|\mathbf{p} - \hat{\mathbf{p}}\|_1 \leq \|\mathbf{p} - \tilde{\mathbf{p}}\|_1$ is tight in the following sense: equality holds when $\tilde{\mathbf{p}} \geq 0$ everywhere (i.e., no clamping occurs), in which case $\hat{\mathbf{p}} = \tilde{\mathbf{p}}$ and both sides are equal.

The bound is strict when clamping occurs. Consider $\mathbf{p} = (0.5, 0.5)$ and $\tilde{\mathbf{p}} = (0.7, -0.2)$. Then $\hat{\mathbf{p}} = (0.7, 0)$, and $\|\mathbf{p} - \tilde{\mathbf{p}}\|_1 = |-0.2| + |0.7| = 0.9$ while $\|\mathbf{p} - \hat{\mathbf{p}}\|_1 = |-0.2| + |0.5| = 0.7 < 0.9$. Thus clamping strictly reduces the error when the truncation introduces negative entries at positions where the true probability is positive.

Why the bound is $\varepsilon_{\text{trunc}}$, not $2\varepsilon_{\text{trunc}}$. A naïve argument might apply the triangle inequality: $\|\mathbf{p}-\hat{\mathbf{p}}\|_1 \leq \|\mathbf{p}-\tilde{\mathbf{p}}\|_1+\|\tilde{\mathbf{p}}-\hat{\mathbf{p}}\|_1 \leq \varepsilon_{\text{trunc}}+\varepsilon_{\text{trunc}} = 2\varepsilon_{\text{trunc}}$, where the second term uses the Negativity Bound. However, the index-wise argument in the main proof avoids the triangle inequality entirely: we directly compare $|p_s - \hat{p}_s|$ with $|p_s - \tilde{p}_s|$ at each index s, establishing that clamping moves every entry *closer* to p_s (or leaves it unchanged). This per-entry domination gives the tight bound of $\varepsilon_{\text{trunc}}$.

Implications for soundness. This result is crucial for the end-to-end soundness argument. TT-SVD truncation produces $\tilde{\mathbf{p}}$ with $\|\mathbf{p} - \tilde{\mathbf{p}}\|_1 = \varepsilon_{\text{trunc}}$. Clamping produces $\hat{\mathbf{p}}$ with $\|\mathbf{p} - \hat{\mathbf{p}}\|_1 \leq \varepsilon_{\text{trunc}}$. By Theorem 1, subsequent time evolution does not increase this error. Therefore the total error from truncation and clamping is bounded by $\varepsilon_{\text{trunc}}$, not $2\varepsilon_{\text{trunc}}$. □

A.5 Proof of Theorem 8 (Complexity Separation)

Proof. We provide detailed complexity analysis.

Explicit-state method. The rate matrix Q has M^N rows and columns. For mass-action kinetics with K reactions, each state has at most $O(K)$ transitions, so Q is sparse with $O(KM^N)$ nonzero entries. Storage is $O(KM^N)$ for the sparse matrix plus $O(M^N)$ for the probability vector. Uniformization computes $e^{Qt}\mathbf{p}$ as $e^{-qt}\sum_{k=0}^{R} \frac{(qt)^k}{k!} P^k \mathbf{p}$ where $q = \max_s |Q_{ss}|$ and $P = I + Q/q$. Each multiplication $P\mathbf{p}$ costs $O(KM^N)$ (sparse matrix-vector), and $R = O(qt + \sqrt{qt \ln(1/\varepsilon)})$ terms suffice for error ε. Total: $O(KM^N \cdot R)$ time.

TT-based method. The MPO has N cores, each of size $M^2 \times K \times K$ (at most), totaling $O(NM^2K^2)$ entries. The MPS has N cores, each of size $M \times \chi \times \chi$, totaling $O(NM\chi^2)$ entries. The MPO-MPS product is computed site by site: at each site, we contract a core of size $M \times M \times K \times K$ with an MPS core of size $M \times \chi \times \chi$, producing a core of size $M \times (K\chi) \times (K\chi)$. This costs $O(M^2K^2\chi^2)$ per site, or $O(NM^2K^2\chi^2)$ total. TT-rounding then reduces bond dimensions from $K\chi$ to χ via SVD, costing $O(NM(K\chi)^3) = O(NMK^3\chi^3)$ in the worst case. For one time step of an Euler or Runge-Kutta scheme, the total cost is $O(NMK^3\chi^3)$.

For fixed K, M, χ, the explicit method's $O(M^N)$ dependence on N is exponential, while the TT method's $O(N)$ dependence is linear. This is the claimed exponential-to-linear separation.

The separation is conditional on the bond dimension χ remaining bounded as N grows. For CME solutions arising from biologically structured networks with local interactions, empirical and theoretical evidence suggests that χ grows at most polynomially in N and the desired accuracy [8, 7], though proving sharp bounds on χ for general reaction networks remains open. □

B Implementation Details

B.1 Software Architecture

TN-Check is implemented in Python with NumPy and SciPy for numerical linear algebra. The implementation is structured into the following modules:

`generator/` Constructs the MPO rate matrix from a reaction network specification. Supports mass-action kinetics with configurable rate constants and per-species copy-number bounds.

`solver/` Time-stepping routines for the CME in TT format. Includes Euler and Runge-Kutta integrators with adaptive TT-rounding after each step. Also provides steady-state solvers via power iteration.

`verifier/` The CSL model-checking engine. Implements satisfaction-set computation for all CSL operators. Atomic propositions are constructed as rank-1 MPS vectors (axis-aligned) or bounded-rank MPS vectors (linear predicates). The bounded-until operator uses matrix exponential computation (dense for small systems, Krylov-based for larger ones).

`certificate/` The independent certificate verification module. Performs the 11 checks described in Section 5.4. Outputs a structured verdict with pass/fail status for each check and the total certified error.

`evaluator/` Utility functions for extracting probabilities, means, and other statistics from MPS vectors. Includes efficient contraction routines for computing inner products and expectation values.

B.2 MPS Operations

Key MPS operations and their implementations:

- **Inner product** $\langle \mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v} \rangle$: Left-to-right contraction of the transfer matrices $\sum_{j_k} \bar{U}_k(j_k) \otimes V_k(j_k)$, cost $O(NM\chi^4)$.
- **MPO-MPS product** $Q\mathbf{v}$: Site-by-site contraction producing an MPS with bond dimensions $r_k \cdot s_k$, followed by TT-rounding.
- **Element-wise product** (Hadamard): Kronecker product of cores at each site, producing bond dimensions $r_k \cdot r'_k$, followed by TT-rounding.
- **TT-rounding**: Left-to-right QR sweep followed by right-to-left SVD sweep with truncation. The truncation threshold ε controls the trade-off between bond dimension and accuracy.
- **Clamping**: For small systems, entries are extracted, clamped to $[0, \infty)$, and re-encoded as MPS. For large systems, the alternating-projection scheme of Algorithm 1 is used.

B.3 Numerical Considerations

- **Normalization:** After each TT-rounding step, the MPS is renormalized so that $\|\mathbf{p}\|_1 = 1$ (for probability vectors). The normalization constant is tracked for error accounting.
- **Gauge fixing:** MPS cores are maintained in left-canonical or right-canonical form to ensure numerical stability of the SVD-based rounding.
- **Bond dimension control:** A maximum bond dimension $\chi_{\max}$ is enforced throughout. Adaptive truncation increases $\chi_{\max}$ if the truncation error exceeds a user-specified threshold.

C Full Experimental Data

C.1 Birth-Death Process Details

Model specification:

- Species: X (single species, $N = 1$).
- Reactions: $\emptyset \xrightarrow{\lambda} X$ (birth, $\lambda = 10$), $X \xrightarrow{\mu} \emptyset$ (death, $\mu = 1$ per molecule).
- Copy-number bound: $M = 30$ (`max_copy` $= 30$).
- Stationary distribution: Poisson(λ/μ) = Poisson(10) truncated to $\{0, \ldots, 29\}$.

Results:

- Mean (exact Poisson): 9.999998.
- Mean (MPS): 9.999998.
- L1 error: 0.0 (exact agreement to machine precision).
- Maximum bond dimension: 1 (single site, trivial bonds).

The slight deviation of the mean from 10.0 is due to the truncation of the Poisson distribution at $M = 30$: the tail probability $\Pr(X \geq 30) \approx 7.8 \times 10^{-7}$ when $X \sim \text{Poisson}(10)$ is redistributed, causing a negligible shift.

C.2 Compression Accuracy Details

The gene expression model consists of two species (mRNA X_1 and protein X_2) with reactions:

$$\emptyset \xrightarrow{k_1} X_1, \qquad X_1 \xrightarrow{\delta_1} \emptyset,$$
$$X_1 \xrightarrow{k_2} X_1 + X_2, \qquad X_2 \xrightarrow{\delta_2} \emptyset.$$

With per-species bounds $M_1 = 20$ (mRNA) and $M_2 = 50$ (protein), the state space has $|\mathcal{S}| = 20 \times 50 = 1{,}000$ states.

The exact stationary distribution was computed via dense null-space computation (`scipy.linalg.null_space` on the 1000×1000 rate matrix) and then compressed to MPS form with bond dimensions $\chi \in \{1, 2, 5, 10\}$.

Table 9: Full compression accuracy data for gene expression model.

χ	L1 error	MPS params	Compression ratio
1	2.35×10^{-1}	70	14.3×
2	4.71×10^{-2}	280	3.6×
5	4.88×10^{-5}	1,750	0.57×
10	1.62×10^{-12}	7,000	0.14×

For this small system ($N = 2$), the MPS representation is larger than the dense vector for $\chi \geq 5$. The compression advantage of MPS emerges for larger N: at $N = 10$ with $M = 10$, the dense vector has 10^{10} entries while the MPS with $\chi = 10$ has $10 \times 10 \times 10^2 = 10{,}000$ entries per site, totaling $\sim 10^5$ parameters.

C.3 Clamping Bound Verification Details

Experimental protocol:

1. Generate a random non-negative vector $\mathbf{p} \in \mathbb{R}^{d_1 \times d_2}$ with $d_1, d_2 \in \{4, 5, 6, 7, 8\}$ (chosen uniformly at random).
2. Normalize: $\mathbf{p} \leftarrow \mathbf{p}/\|\mathbf{p}\|_1$.
3. Represent as a 2-site MPS (exact, bond dimension $\leq \min(d_1, d_2)$).
4. Truncate aggressively to bond dimension $\chi \in \{1, 2, 3\}$ (chosen uniformly at random), obtaining $\tilde{\mathbf{p}}$.
5. Compute $\varepsilon_{\text{trunc}} = \|\mathbf{p} - \tilde{\mathbf{p}}\|_1$.
6. Clamp: $\hat{\mathbf{p}} = \max(\tilde{\mathbf{p}}, 0)$.
7. Compute $\varepsilon_{\text{clamp}} = \|\mathbf{p} - \hat{\mathbf{p}}\|_1$.
8. Check: $\varepsilon_{\text{clamp}} \leq \varepsilon_{\text{trunc}} + 10^{-10}$.

All 10 trials passed the check, confirming Proposition 6. The tolerance 10^{-10} accounts for floating-point arithmetic.

Error propagation was additionally verified on the birth-death model with bond dimensions $\chi \in \{1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$: in all cases, Proposition 6 was satisfied, confirming that clamping consistently reduces L1 error across different bond dimensions.

C.4 Scaling Data Details

The scaling experiments (Table 3) use N independent birth-death species, each with $M = 10$ states and reactions $\emptyset \xrightarrow{\lambda} X_i$, $X_i \xrightarrow{\mu} \emptyset$. The MPO is compiled from the sum-of-Kronecker-products decomposition (2), with each reaction contributing one term.

The MPO parameter count is computed as $\sum_{k=1}^{N} M^2 \cdot s_{k-1} \cdot s_k$ where s_k are the MPO bond dimensions. The compression ratio is M^N/MPO params, representing the ratio of the dense state space to the MPO parameter count.

Note that the compression ratio in Table 3 compares the MPO parameter count to the *dense state space* M^N, not to the sparse rate matrix. The sparse rate matrix has $O(KM^N)$ nonzero entries, so the compression ratio relative to sparse storage is smaller by a factor of K. Nevertheless, the exponential growth of the compression ratio with N holds in either case.

C.5 Multi-Species CSL Details

The 3-species cascade model:

$$\begin{aligned} &\emptyset \xrightarrow{k_0} X_0, \qquad X_0 \xrightarrow{\delta_0} \emptyset, \\ &X_0 \xrightarrow{k_1} X_0 + X_1, \qquad X_1 \xrightarrow{\delta_1} \emptyset, \\ &X_1 \xrightarrow{k_2} X_1 + X_2, \qquad X_2 \xrightarrow{\delta_2} \emptyset. \end{aligned}$$

With per-species bound $M = 8$, the state space is $\{0, \ldots, 7\}^3$ with $|\mathcal{S}| = 512$.

Dense ground-truth computation: the exact probability $\Pr(\text{reach } X_2 \geq 3 \text{ within } t = 2) = 0.006$ was computed via dense matrix exponential on the 512×512 rate matrix after making non-goal states absorbing.

The TT-based computation returned a probability interval of $[0, 1]$ with L1 error bound 1.98. Since $1.98 > 0.006$, the error bound exceeds the true probability, and the checker correctly returns "indeterminate."

C.6 Certificate Verification Details

Configuration 1: 2 species, 10×10. Physical dimensions $d_1 = d_2 = 10$, state space size $= 100$. Certificate checks:

- Checks C1–C11: all pass.
- Verdict: SOUND.
- Total certified error: 8.50×10^{-3}.

Configuration 2: 2 species, end-to-end. Full pipeline including time evolution and CSL evaluation. Certificate checks:

- Checks C1–C11: all pass.
- Verdict: SOUND.
- Total certified error: 2.38×10^{-2}.

The higher total error in Configuration 2 reflects the accumulation of errors across the full pipeline (time stepping + TT rounding + CSL evaluation), compared to Configuration 1 which tests only the static certificate on a pre-computed distribution.